Skilled Independent visa (subclass 189)

Points-tested stream

This visa lets invited workers with skills we need, to live and work permanently anywhere in Australia.

About this visa

- With this visa, you can *(#aboutVisa-index-0)*
- How long you can stay *(#aboutVisa-index-1)*
- Include family *(#aboutVisa-index-2)*
- Cost *(#aboutVisa-index-3)*
- Apply from *(#aboutVisa-index-4)*
- Processing times *(#aboutVisa-index-5)*
- Travel *(#aboutVisa-index-6)*
- Visa label *(#aboutVisa-index-7)*

With this visa, you can

- stay in Australia permanently
- work and study in Australia
- attend free English language classes through the Adult Migrant English Program *(/settling-in-australia/amep/about-the-program)*, if eligible
- enrol in Australia's public health care scheme, Medicare *(http://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/medicare)*
- sponsor your relatives to come to Australia
- travel to and from Australia for 5 years
- if eligible, become and Australian citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*.

Newly arrived residents may need to wait before they can access certain Australian Government payments and benefits *(https://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/enablers/newly-arrived-residents-waiting-period)*.

How long you can stay

This is a permanent visa. It lets you stay in Australia indefinitely. The visa has a travel component that expires 5 years after the date of visa grant.

You become a permanent resident on the day we grant the visa.

For citizenship purposes, your permanent residence starts on the day:

- we grant the visa if you are in Australia
- you enter Australia on this visa if you are outside Australia

Include family

You can include members of the family unit in your application. You can:

- include them when you lodge your visa application
- add them after you lodge your application but before we decide on your visa.

Family members who apply for the visa must meet our health *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* and character *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)* requirements.

If your partner or dependent children are not included in this application, tell us the reason why (for example, they already hold Australian citizenship or are a permanent resident).

Cost

The visa costs AUD6,135.00 for the main applicant (concessions apply in limited circumstances).

There is also a charge for each family member who applies for the visa with you.

To work out what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator?visa=189-63)*.

You might have to pay an extra charge for any applicant 18 years old or older who has less than functional English *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/english-language/functional-english)*. This charge is the second instalment. Pay it only when we ask you to. We ask for the charge only if we are going to grant the visa.

The second instalment charge for family members is AUD4,885.00.

The Visa Pricing Estimator does not include the second instalment or other costs. You might also have to pay other costs for health checks, police certificates and biometrics.

Cost concession for eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste visa applicants

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application.

We will charge eligible applicants the lower visa application cost during the application process in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*. We will recognise eligible applicants by the valid passport from the specified countries used in the application when they apply.

Family members are also eligible for the lower visa cost. We base this on the passport of the primary applicant (or visa holder who satisfies the primary visa criteria).

The primary applicant must hold a valid passport issued by one of the following countries:

- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Nauru
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Republic of the Marshall Islands
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Timor-Leste
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu

Apply from

You can be in or outside Australia when you apply for the visa and when we decide on your application, but not in immigration clearance.

If you apply in Australia, you must hold a substantive visa or a subclass 010 Bridging A visa, a subclass 020 Bridging B visa or a subclass 030 Bridging C visa, otherwise your application will not be processed.

Processing times

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

We assess applications on a case-by-case basis, and actual processing times can vary due to individual circumstances including:

- whether you have lodged a complete application, including all necessary supporting documents
- how quickly you respond to any requests for additional information
- how long it takes to perform required checks on the supporting information provided
- how long it takes to receive additional information from external agencies, particularly in relation to health, character, and national security requirements
- for permanent migration visa applications, how many places are available in the migration program

Travel

You can travel in and out of Australia as many times as you want for 5 years from the date we grant the visa. After 5 years you will need a Resident Return (RRV) visa (subclass 155 or 157) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)* to re-enter Australia as a permanent resident.

Visa label

We will digitally link your visa to your passport. You will not get a label in your passport.

Last updated:
1 July 2026